



MIDSUMMER UN DINGSEGE

21. BROOCHET, 2015

ROBERT LUSCH (MIT DENKI ZUM BRIAN WEIS)
REV - D7

As part of the Ding (Thing), Distelfink will hold a Board of Directors meeting prior to the ceremony, and the organization's leadership will report on that status of finances and of any plans relevant to the community.

Honoring: Sunna, Ziu, Volla, Voll, Vorsetzer (Forseti)

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune intoned thrice: Tiwaz, Sowilo, Fehu, Wunjo

Die Heiliching - The Hallowing

*Hensching, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitz uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe
Bei Wudan un Freid fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeet un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un zu sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.
Bei der Fraa Holle fer es Volk zu erneire
Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide
Hensching, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do zamme, fer der Midsummer zu feiere, fer unserer Sippschaft ihr Fruchsfriede darrich der Ziu umzuhalde, un fer die Ziewe Ziu, Sunna, Volla, un Voll zu ehre. Heel zum Ding! Heel zum Midsummer! Heel zu de Ziewe! Heel zum Lewe! Heel zu der Wonne! Heel zu der Freindschaft! Heel zu der Liewe!

Today we gather together to celebrate the Midsummer, to hold together our Sippschaft's frith through Ziu, and to honor the deities Ziu, Sunna, Volla (Fulla) and Voll (Phol). Hail to the Thing! Hail to the Midsummer! Hail to the deities! Hail to life! Hail to joy! Hail to friendship! Hail to love!

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Invocations to the deities will be made both in Deutsch and in English.

*Liewer Harr Ziu, Himmelzieb!
Mir bidde Dich mit uns zu bsuche
Un mit uns heit unser Fruchsfriede zu feiere
Denki fer dei Beschpiel, wu uns schaut,
was Richtichkeet iss.
Sei unser verehrter Gascht
So kammer mit Dir unser Liewe
un unser Verwandschaft verdeele.*

*Liewi Haerrin Sunna!
Du gebst Lewe un deel
vun deinre Kraft zu der Erd.
Mir griesse Dich un erkenne
Die Kraft un dei Liewe fer uns.
Nau mir verbinne uns widder mit Dir.
Sei unser verherti Gaschtin
Un loss uns brecht un hallich bleiwe!*

*Liewi Haerrin Volla!
Mir wisse so wennich vun Dir
Doch Du uns immer am Hefte bishst.
Denki fer die Wohldaat vun der Sippschaft,
vun de Freindschepde,
vun der Familye, un vun Lewe.
Heel zu Dir, der Freid ihr Schweschder!
Sei unser Gaschtin heit!*

*Beliebter Voll, der Volla ihre Zwidder!
Bekannter zu uns yuscht darrich
der Zwett Merseburg Zauber.
Mach uns vollmechtich un
helf uns Dich besser zu kenne!
Heel zu Dir!
Sei unser Gascht heit!*

Beliebte Ziewe, mir bedanke uns Eich alle.

Heele!

*Beloved Lord Tyr, Sky God!
We bid Thee to visit with us
And to celebrate with us our frith
Thanks for thy example, which shows us
what right action is.
Be our honored Guest
So we can share with Thee
Our love and kinship.*

*Beloved Lady Sunna!
Thou givest Life and some
Of Thy Power to the Earth.
We greet Thee and recognize
This Power and Thy love for us.
Now we again join ourselves with Thee.
Be our honored Guest
And let us stay bright and hale!*

*Beloved Lady Fulla!
We know so little of Thee
But Thou art always helping us.
Thanks for the bounty of the Kindred
Of the Guilds
Of the Family, and of Life.
Hail to Thee, Sister of Frigg
Be our honored Guest today!*

*Beloved Phol, Twin of Fulla
Known to us only through
The Second Merseburg Charm.
Empower us and
Help us to know Thee better!
Hail to Thee!
Be our Guest today!*

Dear Gods and Goddesses, we thank you all!

Hail!

Es Opfer un Die Eed - The Offering and the Oaths

*Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle
Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.*

*If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.
If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.*

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - The Hallowing of the Offerings

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns
Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Ziewe*

*From the gods to the Earth to us
From us to the Earth to the gods*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk
Heele!*

*A gift for a gift.
Hail!*

Zum Schluss - In Closing

Zu de Wichde - To the Wights

Topics for Discussion

This ceremony is actually two combined into one.

The first is the event that we call the Ding or the Dingsege. In Teutonic cultures, the Ding, known in English as the Thing (which is where the overused word “thing” comes from), was the annual gathering of the community. At this event, any legal matters were tended to, squabbles worked out, trade plans negotiated, and the orderly peace (which we call Fruchsfriede) was restored. Our ancestors saw Ziu (Tyr) as the overseer of the Ding. As Ziu is a god of justice, the relationship between Ziu and the Ding certainly makes sense. This is an event that will most likely increase in importance over time. Also, as Ziu's name is related to other Indo-European sky gods (Jupiter, Dyaus Pita, Zeus, etc.), it is clear that Ziu was the original sky god perceived by our ancestors (note: an earlier deity, Tuisto, may have been an earlier identification of Ziu, or he may have been a different deity altogether). Honoring Ziu today is appropriate from both the viewpoints both of the Ding and of the heavens.

The second purpose is the celebration of Midsummer, which is the day with the most daylight minutes of the year. Although we often try to frame this day as representing the victory of light over darkness, the reality is that both light and darkness play important roles in our lives and in the world and universe around us. Being attuned to the cycles of life and the rhythms that guide the streams of life is an important facet of Urglaawe philosophy. In the dead of winter, we are typically isolated and introspective. Deutsch tradition tells us that at those times, we are to assess ourselves, our deeds, our desires, and to find ways to improve our lives.

We are now on the opposite end of the year. We have planted the seeds for things we have set out to do, whether it be growth, change, or even increased stability. This is the time to enjoy life... to be social... to reach out to others and strengthen the bonds of community, to revel in the miracles and wonders of life and everything that it has to offer. This is a time to look at the things in life that weigh us down and to recognize that we must not allow burdens to cause the joys of life to pass us by. Look for signs that guide us towards an understanding of the reasons that things, (bad and good) happen and what role the events, people, change, emotions, etc., will play in the next phase of our lives. If nothing else, for one day, or for a few hours, let go of the burdens... Celebrate life with the people who have gathered here in common purpose. Pick up a percussion instrument and join the rhythm!

As one might expect, at Midsummer we honor the goddess Sunna, who is not the “goddess of the sun” or simply “the sun” per se. Instead, Sunna is the goddess whom we see in the life-giving sunlight. While we also may hail the rain deities (Dunner and Frey), today we will recognize the twin abundance gods of the Ase: Volla and Her twin brother, Voll.

Volla is sometimes referred to as the sister or handmaiden of Frigg, and She is also associated with a Romanized name of Abundanzia. Both names, Volla (Fulla) and Abundanzia, may reveal what our ancestors saw in Her: bounty, fullness, and abundance. In most cases, we would assume that this refers more to physical objects, such as crops and wealth. Indeed, this perception is correct. However, today, the fullness upon which we are to focus is that of community and of life.

Perhaps more mysterious is Voll, known through the Second Merseburg Incantation as Phol. In earlier eras, it was believed that Phol was Balder, the son of Wudan and Frigg. However, current thinking is that Phol's name, when spelled as Voll, reflects a twin relationship with Volla, and that He is therefore a brother of Volla and Frigg.

Second Merseburg Charm:

Phol ende uuodan uuorun zi holza.
du uuart demo balderes uolon sin uuoze birenkit.
thu biguol en sinthgunt, sunna era suister;
thu biguol en friia, uolla era suister;
thu biguol en uuodan, so he uuola conda:
sose benrenki, sose blutrenki, sose lidirenki:
ben zi bena, blut si bluoda,
lid zi geliden, sose gelimida sin!

Phol and Wodan were riding to the woods,
and the foot of Balder's foal was sprained
So Sinthgunt, Sunna's sister, conjured it.
and Frija, Volla's sister, conjured it.
and Wodan conjured it, as well he could:
Like bone-sprain, so blood-sprain,
so joint-sprain:
Bone to bone, blood to blood,
joints to joints, so may they be glued.

Hospitality (Uffwaarting)

Hospitality is one of the Noble Virtues of Heathenry. Being a good host is ordained in the Hávamál:

v. 2

All hail to the givers!

A guest hath come say where shall he sit?

*In haste is he to the hall who
cometh, to find a place by the fire.*

v. 3

*The warmth seeketh who hath
wandered long and is numb about his knees;
meat and dry clothes the man
needeth over the fells who hath fared.*

Simple English version

Praise to the generous and hospitable!

A guest has arrived; where shall he sit?

*Hurriedly he seeks a place by the fire
to warm himself.*

*A man has been out in the cold
he's numb from his feet to his knees and seeks the
warmth of the fire. He's traveled over the mountains and is
wet and hungry, in need of food and dry clothing.*

Reciprocity is an important aspect of Heathen interaction and frith. Thus, guests also have responsibilities.

v. 4

*A drink needeth to full dishes
who cometh, a towel, and the prayer to partake;
good bearing eke, to be well liked
and be bidden to banquet again.*

*A man who comes to a meal will need something to drink.
A towel to wipe his hands, a friendly offering from the host
that he should eat. If he conducts himself well, he will be
invited back again.*

v. 35

*Get thee gone betimes; a guest
should not stay too long in one stead;
lief grows loath if too long one sits
on bench, though in he was bidden.*

*A man should not overstay his welcome but send himself
home in a timely manner. Although dear to his hosts, if he
lingers too long, they will soon detest him
and not invite him back again.*

*Although these words came from an era in which traveling was much more dangerous, the same rules still apply.
Being a good host is extremely important; it is also important to be a good guest.*

Notes on Uniqueness

As we approach Midsummer, I am enjoying standing outside among the many plants in my garden, in parks, or in the forest. Many plants are reaching their peak, at which time I will cut them back and harvest their bounty. Each time that I harvest a perennial plant, I consider the similarities and differences of each branch. Although these are the same plants that I harvested last year, they are also different. The roots have changed since the winter thaw. The appearance projected by the plant, the size, the shape, and the structure of the leaves are different each time the plant grows, yet they are similar enough to be recognized. The plant's spirit remains in the roots throughout the changes of season.

Although plants have a very different constituency and soul construct from humans, we can see a bit of ourselves in the yearly cycle of perennial plants. Their physical form comes into existence from other plants of their species, and, throughout the life of the plant, each is a unique entity. The roots grow in different directions and patterns. The leaves and stems reflect the DNA inherited from the parent plants, yet no two plants are identical.

This is how human life is. Although we are similar to one another in many ways, we are each unique in our current life. Although Urglaawe is a faith in which most members embrace the concept of partial-soul rebirth, it is important to understand just how precious and special each life is.

There are three parts of the soul that we view as being the most likely to be eternal, though they do not necessarily remain together in each lifetime. The eternal "spark" is the Hoch, or the Higher Self or Hugh. This is the part that is truly of "us." Another part most likely to continue on from lifetime to lifetime are the Urleeg (primal layer), which are aspects of our spiritual being that are inherited at conception and cannot be altered. The third eternal part of the soul is the Folyer ("follower") or the Fetch, which is actually a separate entity that forms a sacred partnership with the Hoch and becomes part of the soul construct.

Each time our Hoch is reborn, it inherits its Urleeg and connects with a Folyer and a new soul construct builds around these three aspects of our being. Our being is a complicated and wondrous structure. Although we bear similarities to past incarnations, we are not exactly the same person. Instead, each soul construct, along with its physical shell, is unique and precious in each lifetime. The value of life and the miracle of existence belong to each of us.

Circumstances in life often deplete us of our energy and cloud our view of our own value. The gods gave us emotions for a reason, so it is not inherently bad to feel down, angry, or unhappy from time to time. However, we must not allow the chaos of our current society and the stresses of life to control us.

We will be discussing these items in more detail than will be put to paper here, but, whenever you consider your place in the world or feel hapless or hopeless, remember that each of us is a unique product of millions of years of physical, mental, and conscious evolution. It is up to each of us to make the most of who and what we are so as best to serve the purposes of existence and of life.

Vorsetzer

The Ase god Forseti is somewhat mysterious. He was not known in our lore. We know from the *Prose Edda* that He is the son of Balder and Nanna and that he is renowned as a mediator god. His name is set into Deutsch as Vorsetzer, which would mean "one who presides" or "one who sets forth," but the origin of the name Forseti itself is not 100% certain. It may have roots in seafaring words that translate to "cataract," and the name may have a linguistic relationship to the Greek Poseidon.

What is known is that He was highly honored among the Frisians as "Fosite" and that there was an island between Frisia and Denmark called Fositeland. On that island was a holy spring consecrated to Fosite, and water could only be drawn from that spring in complete silence. The spring was later defiled. We now know this island as Heligoland or Helgoland, which is a German possession in the North Sea but is still most heavily populated by Frisians.